

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

02 September 2026

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Qualified Advocate role in Blake Morgan's Regulatory team in Reading. Advocacy in fitness to practise proceedings sits at the intersection of procedural rigour and public protection, and it is a practice area I have been working toward deliberately. My background in disputes work, legal research and case preparation at BCLP and Citizens Advice, combined with my LLM in Comparative and International Dispute Resolution, has given me a foundation in contested proceedings that I want to develop into specialist regulatory advocacy.

At BCLP, I supported a complex investment arbitration through to a significant procedural deadline, reviewing evidence, drafting procedural orders and coordinating documents across the team. I became the only junior supporting the matter shortly before submission and took responsibility for tracking outstanding actions and ensuring the filing was on time. That experience taught me how contested proceedings work under pressure, and the feedback from the partner and associate was that my work was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor. In the Real Estate Disputes rotation, I assisted with hearing preparation, including electronic bundles, skeleton arguments and court materials, across several matters running simultaneously.

At Citizens Advice, I work with clients on welfare, housing, employment and debt matters, many of whom are vulnerable and unfamiliar with legal processes. I take detailed factual statements, identify evidential gaps, draft correspondence and prepare applications, then explain what the process requires in terms they can actually use. Translating procedural complexity into clear, practical guidance is something I do in almost every matter, and it is directly relevant to supporting individuals or regulators navigating fitness to practise proceedings.

Blake Morgan's Regulatory team acts for a range of professional regulators, including the SRA, across sectors where the stakes for the individuals involved are high. That combination of public protection work and technically demanding contested hearings is what draws me to this role specifically. My LLM dissertation examined data protection across jurisdictions, and my broader LLM programme covered international arbitration and procedural issues in depth, so the analytical and procedural side of regulatory proceedings is familiar ground. This role is the next step in developing that into a specialist practice.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva